

Slide 6: Challenges and Current Status

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WikiLeaks has faced numerous challenges in recent years, significantly impacting its operations and ability to publish:

Legal Battles and Imprisonment

Julian Assange, WikiLeaks' founder, was released from prison in June 2024 after pleading guilty to an Espionage Act charge^[1]. He had spent five years in a UK prison fighting extradition to the United States.

Limited Publishing Capacity

As of 2023, Assange stated that WikiLeaks is no longer able to publish due to his imprisonment and the effects of US government surveillance and funding restrictions on potential whistleblowers^[2].

Technical Issues

In November 2022, much of WikiLeaks' content disappeared from its website, reducing the number of available documents from around 10 million to approximately 3,000^[2:1]. The site also experienced issues with its search functionality and submission page.

Financial Blockade

WikiLeaks has faced ongoing financial challenges due to payment intermediaries like PayPal, Mastercard, and Visa suspending or terminating their services to the organization^[2:2].

Public Appearances

Following his release, Assange made his first public appearance on October 1, 2024, addressing the Council of Europe^[3]. He used this platform to discuss his experiences and the challenges faced by WikiLeaks.

Current Focus

Since Assange's release, WikiLeaks has been working to rebuild its infrastructure and regain its ability to receive and publish leaked documents. However, the organization's future remains uncertain as it navigates the aftermath of legal challenges and operational setbacks.



1. <https://www.outlookbusiness.com/news/wikileaks-julian-assange-to-make-first-public-statement-since-his-release-from-prison>

2. <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/WikiLeaks>

3. <https://www.dw.com/en/julian-assange-makes-first-public-address-since-release/a-70372957>